

Singer of Life

Text: From a Texcoco Nahuatl poem

Music: Plains Indian traditional, 1879

LACQUIPARLE irregular

The musical score is written on three staves in 2/2 time, with a key signature of three flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat). The melody is simple, using quarter and half notes, with some dotted rhythms. Chord symbols (Bbm, Ebm, Bbm) are placed above the staff at the beginning of each line and above specific notes in the second and third lines. The lyrics are written below the staff, with line numbers 1 and 2 indicating different verses. The first line of music corresponds to the first line of lyrics. The second line of music corresponds to the second line of lyrics. The third line of music corresponds to the third line of lyrics. The score ends with a double bar line.

1 Sing - er of Life, all flow - ers are songs, with pet - als do you write.
2 Mor - tal are we, with all liv - ing things, with ea - gles in the sky.

Sing - er of Life, you col - or the earth, daz - zling the eye with birds red and bright.
E - ven all gold and jade will not last; sing - ing a - lone, I know, can - not die.

Joy is for us! The flow - ers are spread! Sing - ing is our de - light!
Here in this house of spring - time be - stow songs that like birds can fly.